👩‍🏫 Staff Guide · Horticulture 1 · Unit 8 Poinsettias (Level 2)

Level 2 = about 3rd-grade reading. SLE students stay in the class teacher's lesson and use these pieces next to it: same topics, same order, same points.

1. How the pieces line up

Gen ed piece (Canvas: "Unit 8 Poinsettias (textbook Unit 13): Unit 13 questions, care chart, common pests, growing instructions, sale flier, Smith Gardens field trip, 3-plant experiment lab report, Poinsettia Portfolio, Poinsettia quizzes + final")	**Level 2 piece**
Unit 13 Questions + textbook Unit 13	Slides + notes (facts rewritten; scans not posted)
Care chart (date/action/observation)	Poinsettia Care lab packet
Common pests poster, growing instructions	Slides "Problems" + notes C
3-plant experiment + lab report	Lab Report Frame packet (L1 picture choices, L2 sentence starters, L3 paragraph frame)
Sale flier, Smith Gardens trip, Poinsettia Portfolio	Slide "Sale and Portfolio"
Poinsettia quizzes (9 + 8 Qs) + paper final	Modified quiz + game
Class slides	Deck: 19 slides, Words to Know first, hold-up-1-2-3 checks, recap
Her worksheets (grouped into lessons)	Guided notes: 11 items + key
Class quiz / notes check	Quiz: 10 questions + key
Vocabulary	9 picture cards (cut apart)
—	1 game on the class site: 10 questions + a matching round

2. Supports built in

- Short lines, key words bold, word bank in every notes box
- Quiz: 3 choices, no "all of the above"
- Real poinsettia to look at: point to bracts vs. cyathia
- Money at the sale: student is paired with staff

3. Add these as the IEP allows

- Read-aloud · extended time · separate setting
- Printed slides · videos paused at the "look for" part

4. What to grade

- Portfolio (60 pts): Level 1 = cover, care chart, thank-you card with pictures; Level 2 = all parts with sentence starters
- **Notes**: same points as her worksheets for that lesson when complete.
- **Quiz**: score, then scale to the class points.
- These are **modifications** (less content). The IEP must allow modified grading. Check with the case manager.

5. Who to ask

- Mr. Driver (SLE): changes and IEP questions.
- Facts we could not confirm in her files say "check with the class teacher".

🚧 Under construction (check with the class teacher)

- **Poinsettia Final Test**: Paper final not in the export; use our quiz.
- **Common Poinsettia Pests**: Assigned in class; not in the export.
- **Smith Gardens field trip**: Signed travel form + medical info required (in the syllabus packet).

💗 Note

Poinsettia sap: latex-family irritant. Check health plans for latex allergy; use nitrile gloves. Students never handle pesticides or growth regulators.

⚠️ Safety: tools and plants

- **Tools**: students may use all tools (pruners, knives, floral wire, low-temp glue guns) **with an adult right there**. Staff hand tools out, stay at the station, and count them back in. Cut-resistant gloves if possible.
- **Poinsettia sap** is milky and can irritate skin and eyes. Gloves on, no rubbing eyes, wash hands after.
- **Latex**: poinsettias are in the latex family. Students with a latex allergy wear non-latex (nitrile) gloves or skip handling; check health plans.
- **Bees and pollen**: check IEP/health plans for bee-sting or pollen allergies and know where the EpiPen is before greenhouse work.
- **Mouths**: no plants, soil, seeds, berries, fertilizer or rooting hormone in mouths. Students who mouth objects or have pica need one-to-one eyes in the greenhouse. Many plants (holly and mistletoe berries, some houseplants) are poisonous.
- **Chemicals**: rooting hormone and fertilizer with gloves, then wash hands. Pesticides and growth regulators are staff/teacher only; students never spray or handle them.

- **Greenhouse**: wet floors and hoses (slips), heat (water breaks), wet dry potting mix first (dust).

👩🏾‍🏫 Staff Guide · Poinsettia Care & Pinching (Level 2)

Horticulture 1 · Unit 8 · goes with the class “Care chart + Pinching Plants + Growing Instructions” (4 pts per week). Level 2 = about 3rd-grade reading. Same activity, same day, same points as the class.

1. The pieces

- **Task card**: Modified from the class “Care chart + Pinching Plants + Growing Instructions”. 8 steps, one per box.
- **Prep sheet**: jobs, tools checklist, safety. Do it the day before or at the start.
- **Slides**: jobs, safety, steps, 3 checks.
- **Reflection**: replaces the written parts.
- **Game**: on the class site.

2. Prompts while they work

- Show me the first step.
- Which tool do we need now?
- Where do our hands go when the tool is cutting?
- What should we do when we finish?

3. Modifications

- Task card instead of written directions
- Sentence starters on the reflection
- Partner reads directions aloud

4. What to grade (4 pts per week)

- Steps done (photo proof)
- Reflection: 2 sentences per box
- Pointing, saying, or circling counts as a full answer.
- Modified grading only as the IEP allows. Check with the case manager.

5. Ask

- Mr. Driver (SLE).

⚠️ Safety: tools and plants

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- **Poinsettia sap** is milky and can irritate skin and eyes. Gloves on, no rubbing eyes, wash hands after.
- **Latex**: poinsettias are in the latex family. Students with a latex allergy wear non-latex (nitrile) gloves or skip handling; check health plans.
- **Bees and pollen**: check IEP/health plans for bee-sting or pollen allergies and know where the EpiPen is before greenhouse work.
- **Mouths**: no plants, soil, seeds, berries, fertilizer or rooting hormone in mouths. Students who mouth objects or have pica need one-to-one eyes in the greenhouse. Many plants (holly and mistletoe berries, some houseplants) are poisonous.
- **Chemicals**: rooting hormone and fertilizer with gloves, then wash hands. Pesticides and growth regulators are staff/teacher only; students never spray or handle them.
- **Greenhouse**: wet floors and hoses (slips), heat (water breaks), wet dry potting mix first (dust).

Poinsettia Notes

Horticulture 1 · Unit 8 Poinsettias · Level 2 guided notes. Use with the class slides.

Name: _____

Fill in each blank with a word from the word bank in that box. Each word is used one time.

A. Basics

1. Poinsettias are native to _____.
2. The colored parts are _____; the true flowers are the yellow _____.

Word bank: **bracts** **cyathia** **Mexico**

B. Photoperiod

3. Poinsettias are _____-day plants.
4. They need about _____ hours of darkness each night to color.

Word bank: **14** **short**

C. Care and problems

5. Water the soil when the surface is _____.
6. Gray mold from wet leaves is _____.
7. Brown roots from overwatering is root _____.
8. Match the pest:

Whiteflies	fine webbing
Mealybugs	cottony spots
Mites	tiny white insects

Word bank: **botrytis** **dry** **rot**

Level 2 version of the gen ed “Unit 13 Questions + Growing Instructions + Pests.”

📖 Poinsettias: Vocabulary Picture Cards (Level 2)

Name: _____

Cut on the dashed lines. Use the cards to match, sort, or quiz a partner.



Poinsettia

A plant from Mexico grown for its colorful bracts and sold in November and December.



Bract

The colored leaf-like part of a poinsettia. It looks like a petal but is a modified leaf.



Cyathia

The small yellow true flowers in the center of the bracts.



Short days

Poinsettias need long, totally dark nights (about 14 hours) to change color.



Photoperiod

The length of daylight. It controls when some plants bloom or color.



Whitefly

A common poinsettia pest: tiny white insects under the leaves.



Botrytis

A fungus disease (gray mold) that grows when leaves stay wet.



Sap

Poinsettia sap is milky and can irritate skin and eyes. Latex allergy risk: wear nitrile gloves.



Sleeve

A plastic or paper sleeve that protects the plant from cold and damage when carried home.

🌺 Poinsettia Care & Pinching

Horticulture 1 · Unit 8 · Level 2



Name: _____

Modified from the class “Care chart + Pinching Plants + Growing Instructions”.

🧺 Supplies

- ☐ 🌺 **My poinsettia**
- ☐ 📋 **Care chart** date, action, observation
- ☐ 🚿 **Watering can**
- ☐ 🧤 **Nitrile gloves** sap
- ☐ 🔍 **Hand lens** pests
- ☐ 🏷️ **Label**

🌺 Steps: check each box when you finish

1. 🧤 Nitrile gloves on (sap). ☐
2. 👆 Check soil moisture with a finger. ☐
3. 💧 If dry, water the soil until it drains; keep leaves dry. ☐
4. 🔍 Inspect leaf undersides for whiteflies, mealybugs, mites. ☐
5. ✌️ Pinching week: pinch the top inch above a leaf to make it bushy. ☐
6. 📏 Measure height; count bracts coloring. ☐
7. 📋 Log date, action and observation on the care chart. ☐
8. 🧼 Wash hands; tell staff about any pests. ☐

💡 *Pinching is usually done once in late summer; skip that step if the crop is past it.*

🌺 Poinsettia Care & Pinching · Prep Sheet

Horticulture 1 · Unit 8 · Level 2



Name: _____

👥 Job roles: circle your job. Initial when it is done.

Job	What you do	Done ✔️
🧑‍🌾 **Grower**	Does the main plant job with the tools	
🧺 **Supply helper**	Gets and returns supplies and tools to staff	
📸 **Recorder**	Takes photos and fills in the chart	
🧽 **Clean-up captain**	Sweeps, wipes tables, checks hands are washed	

🧰 Tools and supplies: check when you have it

- ☐ 🌺 **My poinsettia**
- ☐ 📋 **Care chart** date, action, observation
- ☐ 🚿 **Watering can**
- ☐ 🧤 **Nitrile gloves** sap
- ☐ 🔍 **Hand lens** pests
- ☐ 🏷️ **Label**

⚠️ Safety and manners focus

- 🧤 Wear **gloves** for soil, sap, fertilizer and rooting hormone.
- 👄 **Nothing in your mouth**: no plants, soil, seeds or berries.
- ✂️ Sharp tools only with an **adult at the station**. Cut away from your body.
- 🥛 Milky **sap** stings eyes and skin; latex allergy = nitrile gloves or skip.
- 🧪 **Staff only** spray pests. Students never touch sprays.
- 🧼 **Wash hands** when you finish.

✅ Before you start

☐ Gloves ☐ Apron ☐ Adult at station

🌺 Poinsettia Care & Pinching · Reflection

Horticulture 1 · Unit 8 · Level 2



Name: _____

📸 My photos / proof

☐ Before photo ☐ During photo ☐ Finished photo

✅ Skills I used today (check all you did)

☐ 🧤 Used gloves and tools safely

☐ 🌱 Finished the Poinsettia Care & Pinching steps

☐ 🧽 Cleaned up and returned tools

☐ 🤝 Did my job role

What did you do today, in order?

1. _____
2. _____

Ideas: **First…** **Next…** **Last…**

What did you learn about plants?

1. _____
2. _____

Ideas: **Plants need…** **I saw…** **Next time…**

🔬 Poinsettia 3-Plant Experiment: Lab Report Frame

Horticulture 1 · Unit 8 · Level 2 · goes with “How to Write a Scientific Lab Report”

Name: _____

Title and Introduction

Our experiment tested _____. We wanted to find out if _____.

Materials and Method

We used 3 poinsettias. Plant 1 got _____, plant 2 got _____, plant 3 got _____ (control).

Results and Graph

Plant ___ grew the most. Its height went from ___ cm to ___ cm. (Make a bar graph.)

Discussion

I think plant ___ did best because _____.

Conclusion

Our prediction was (right / wrong). Next time we would _____.

✅ Poinsettias Quiz

Horticulture 1 · Unit 8 · Level 2 (modified). 10 questions · 3 choices each · 1 point each.

Name: _____

Circle the best answer. You may have the questions read aloud.

1. 🇲🇽 Poinsettias are native to…

A. Canada | B. Mexico | C. China

2. 🟥 Poinsettias get their color in the…

A. Flowers | B. Florets | C. Bracts

3. 🌙 To change color, a poinsettia needs…

A. Short days (long nights) | B. Long days | C. Fertilizer

4. 🟡 The poinsettia flower is…

A. Red | B. Blue | C. Yellow

5. 🍄 Poinsettias are prone to which fungal disease?

A. Botrytis (gray mold) | B. Rust | C. Powdery mildew only

6. ⏰ Photoperiod refers to…

A. The pot size | B. The length of the light period | C. Fertilizer amount

7. 🎁 Poinsettias are sleeved to…

A. Hide pests | B. Protect them in transport and from cold | C. Make them heavier

8. 🟤 Overwatering causes browning roots called…

A. Root rot | B. Bract burn | C. Leaf spot

9. 💧 Keep water off the foliage because…

A. Leaves get too heavy only | B. It makes them grow | C. It can cause botrytis and damage

10. 🧤 Poinsettia sap…

A. Can irritate skin and eyes; wear gloves | B. Is safe to taste | C. Is used as glue

🌺 Poinsettia Notes · ANSWER KEY

Horticulture 1 · Unit 8 Poinsettias · Level 2 guided notes. Use with the class slides.

Name: _____

Fill in each blank with a word from the word bank in that box. Each word is used one time.

A. Basics

1. Poinsettias are native to **Mexico**.
2. The colored parts are **bracts**; the true flowers are the yellow **cyathia**.

Word bank: **bracts** · **cyathia** · **Mexico**

B. Photoperiod

3. Poinsettias are **short**-day plants.
4. They need about **14** hours of darkness each night to color.

Word bank: **14** · **short**

C. Care and problems

5. Water the soil when the surface is **dry**.
6. Gray mold from wet leaves is **botrytis**.
7. Brown roots from overwatering is root **rot**.
8. Match the pest:

(Key: Whiteflies → tiny white insects · Mealybugs → cottony spots · Mites → fine webbing)

Whiteflies	fine webbing
Mealybugs	cottony spots
Mites	tiny white insects

Word bank: **botrytis** · **dry** · **rot**

Level 2 version of the gen ed "Unit 13 Questions + Growing Instructions + Pests."
🔑 Key written by our team from the class teacher's materials, please check.

✅ Poinsettias Quiz · ANSWER KEY

Horticulture 1 · Unit 8 · Level 2 (modified). 10 questions · 3 choices each · 1 point each.

Name: _____

Circle the best answer. You may have the questions read aloud.

1. 🇲🇽 Poinsettias are native to… Test Q1

- A. Canada
- **B. Mexico**
- C. China

2. 🟥 Poinsettias get their color in the… Test Q2

- A. Flowers
- B. Florets
- **C. Bracts**

3. 🌙 To change color, a poinsettia needs… Test Q3

- **A. Short days (long nights)**
- B. Long days
- C. Fertilizer

4. 🟡 The poinsettia flower is… Test Q4

- A. Red
- B. Blue
- **C. Yellow**

5. 🍄 Poinsettias are prone to which fungal disease? Test Q5

- **A. Botrytis (gray mold)**
- B. Rust
- C. Powdery mildew only

6. ⏰ Photoperiod refers to… Test Q6

- A. The pot size
- **B. The length of the light period**
- C. Fertilizer amount

7. 🎁 Poinsettias are sleeved to… Test Q7

- A. Hide pests
- **B. Protect them in transport and from cold**
- C. Make them heavier

8. 🟤 Overwatering causes browning roots called… Test Q8

- **A. Root rot**
- B. Bract burn
- C. Leaf spot

9. 💧 Keep water off the foliage because… Test Q9

- A. Leaves get too heavy only
- B. It makes them grow
- **C. It can cause botrytis and damage**

10. 🧤 Poinsettia sap… Safety

- **A. Can irritate skin and eyes; wear gloves**
- B. Is safe to taste
- C. Is used as glue

Answers

1-B · 2-C · 3-A · 4-C · 5-A · 6-B · 7-B · 8-A · 9-C · 10-A

Reworded from the gen ed “Poinsettia Test (9 Qs with key)”. Score: __ / 10. 🔑 Key written by our team from 's materials, please check.